Decent Coaching Classes

VIII CBSE

Subject: History — ANSWER KEY

Chapter: From Trade to Territory — The Company Establishes Power

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Section A — Multiple Choice Questions [5]

1. (b) 1598
2. (b) Siraj-ud-Daulah
3. (c) Lord Dalhousie
4. (b) Satyendranath Tagore
5. (b) Maharaja Ranjit Singh

Section B — Very Short Answer Questions [8]

1. Under Dual Administration (1765), Robert Clive kept the diwani (revenue collection) rights with the Company, while the responsibility of actual governance was left with Indian officials (the nawab's administration). The Company enjoyed the powers of revenue collection but did not take on the responsibility of administration.

2. Any two: the policy of Subsidiary Alliance; the Doctrine of Lapse; direct annexation after war/defeat (e.g., through treaties like the Treaty of Bassein).

3. Tipu Sultan, the ruler of Mysore (1782–99), was known as the 'Tiger of Mysore'. He earned this title for his bravery, fearless spirit and military genius, notably shown when he fought off a tiger with his bare hands; the tiger also became a symbol of his courage and resistance against the British.

4. Under the Subsidiary Alliance (introduced by Governor-General Richard Wellesley), Indian rulers who accepted it had to keep a British army in their state (paying for its maintenance) and were not allowed to have their own independent armed forces or form alliances with other rulers without British approval, making them dependent on British protection.

Section C — Short Answer Questions [9]

1. Causes: Growing tension between the East India Company and Siraj-ud-Daulah, the nawab of Bengal, over trade privileges — the Company's misuse of duty-free trade rights, fortification of its factory without permission, and interference in Bengal's affairs. When the nawab attacked and seized the Company's factory at Calcutta, the Company sent Robert Clive with troops. Clive secretly conspired with Mir Jafar, one of Siraj-ud-Daulah's commanders, who refused to fight. Results: Siraj-ud-Daulah was defeated in 1757; Mir Jafar was installed as the new nawab (a puppet ruler); the battle marked the beginning of Company rule in India, as the nawab became increasingly dependent on the British.

2. Lord Cornwallis restructured British India's judicial system: he established the Indian Judicial system, relied on religious texts, and started many reforms. District courts were reconstituted, and Europeans were not allowed to be tried in Indian-run courts. Civil servants were selected to serve as district collectors (diwani/judicial officers), and criminal courts were supervised by qazis and muftis, who applied Muslim laws, but were themselves supervised by European district collectors.

3. The Company built a fort around its Bengal settlement (1696–98) and obtained zamindari rights over three villages, including Kalikata (later Calcutta), by bribing Mughal officials. It also secured a farman from Emperor Aurangzeb allowing duty-free trade. However, Company merchants and officials misused this privilege for their own private trade without paying duties, which caused heavy revenue losses to Bengal and angered Murshid Quli Khan, the nawab, leading to growing tension.

Section D — Long Answer Question [5]

1. Subsidiary Alliance: Introduced by Governor-General Richard Wellesley (1798–1805), under this policy an Indian ruler who accepted the alliance had to maintain a British army within his state (and pay for its upkeep), give up the right to have an independent armed force, and could not form alliances or fight wars without British consent. In return, the British promised to protect the ruler. This made the allied states dependent on British power and easy for the Company to control indirectly, e.g., the Nizam of Hyderabad and rulers of Awadh, Mysore and the Maratha states accepted this alliance.

   Doctrine of Lapse: Introduced by Lord Dalhousie (1848–56), this policy stated that if a ruler of a state died without a natural male heir, his state would 'lapse' and become part of British territory, and an adopted heir would not be recognised as the ruler. Using this doctrine, the British annexed several states, e.g., Satara (1848), Sambalpur (1850), Udaipur (1852), Nagpur (1853) and Jhansi (1854). Together, both policies allowed the British to expand their territorial control over India without direct warfare, taking over many princely states.

Section E — Source-Based Question [3]

(i) The East India Company received its first charter from Queen Elizabeth I in 1600.

(ii) The Company set up its first trading post in India at Surat in 1612.

(iii) The 15-year exclusive charter meant no other English trading group could compete with the Company, giving it a monopoly over English trade with Eastern countries and allowing it to purchase goods from India cheaply and sell them at higher profits in Europe without competition from fellow Englishmen.